JOHN MICAH MERCADO

Information Technology Professional | Cybersecurity & Security Operations
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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Cybersecurity-focused IT professional with CompTIA Security+, CySA+, Network+, Server+, and A+ certifications and a B.S. in Information Technology. Hands-on experience in network traffic analysis, session-security testing, vulnerability assessment, SQL injection remediation, and controlled penetration-testing labs. Four years of U.S. Army technical maintenance experience built on systematic troubleshooting, root-cause analysis, technical documentation, and team leadership under pressure. Seeking an entry-level role in cybersecurity support, security operations, or a SOC analyst pathway.

CERTIFICATIONS

CompTIA CySA+ 10/2026
CompTIA Security+ 12/2024
CompTIA A+ 09/2026
CompTIA Network+ 09/2026
CompTIA Server+ 09/2026

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Security Operations & Analysis:** Network Traffic & Packet Analysis (Wireshark), Vulnerability Assessment, Intrusion Detection, Digital Forensics, Root-Cause Analysis, Technical Documentation
- **Offensive & Defensive Security:** Penetration Testing (lab), Session Hijacking & Remediation, SQL Injection & Remediation, WAF Rules, Secure Coding, Data Validation
- **Networking & Systems:** TCP/IP, LAN, Network Troubleshooting, Systems Administration, Linux, Cloud Computing
- **Scripting & Development:** Python, Java, Kotlin, C#, JavaScript, TypeScript, SQL, HTML/CSS; Git, GitHub
- **Automation & AI:** AI-Assisted Development (Cursor, Antigravity), Generative AI (Gemini), Prompt Engineering

CYBERSECURITY PROJECTS & LABS

Security Testing and Remediation Labs | Personal *June 2024 – December 2025*

- Captured HTTP/HTTPS traffic with Wireshark, extracted session cookies, and demonstrated session replay and hijacking attacks, then mitigated them with encryption, secure flags, and session rotation, expiration, and fingerprinting.
- Performed SQL injection attacks on vulnerable test environments and remediated findings with parameterized queries, input validation, and WAF rules.
- Deployed reverse TCP payloads using custom Python scripts in controlled labs, establishing persistent channels and simulating post-exploitation exfiltration to understand attacker tradecraft and detection opportunities.

Customer Churn Pipeline (C#) | Personal *March 2026*

- Built an application that parses and validates CSV records and analyzes behavioral indicators (login frequency, spending, tenure, support issues) to flag high-risk accounts.

Web and Mobile Development Projects | Personal *May 2026 – July 2026*

- Built a full-stack app with Express, React, TypeScript, and SQLite3; an Android financial calculator (FinCal) in Java/Kotlin with Jetpack Compose and input validation; and a portfolio site on GitHub Pages. Managed in GitHub.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

AI Integration Specialist (Internship) | IPMD, Inc., Remote, San Mateo, CA *07/2026 – 10/2026*

- Evaluated AI platforms (Cursor, Antigravity, Gemini) and built prompts and workflows to automate tasks; launched a functional website during onboarding.

Wheeled Vehicle Mechanic | U.S. Army, Fort Bragg, NC *08/2018 – 09/2022*

- Diagnosed complex mechanical, electrical, powertrain, and fuel-system failures using systematic fault isolation and root-cause analysis, the same methodical approach applied to incident triage.
- Led teams of mechanics on special missions in austere, high-risk environments, coordinating diagnostics, recovery, and repairs under strict deadlines.
- Performed preventive maintenance checks and services (PMCS) to identify and correct potential failures before they affected mission capability.
- Followed technical manuals and procedures while maintaining strict compliance with safety, hazardous-material, and risk-mitigation protocols.

EDUCATION & TECHNICAL TRAINING

Bachelor of Science in Information Technology | University of North Florida, Jacksonville, FL *07/2026*
Coursework: Cybersecurity Systems, Intrusion Detection, Digital Forensics, Computer Networks, Systems Administration, Cloud Computing, IT Project Management

CompTIA Career Development Program (A+, Network+, Server+, Security+, CySA+) | Star V Learning Centers *08/2026 – 10/2026*